

SMART (Self-Monitoring, Analysis and Reporting Technology) tasks such as printing the SMART self-test and error logs, enabling and disabling SMART automatic testing, and initiating device self-tests. When the command is used with the `-i` switch, it gives information about the disk.

The output of the above command will show the model family, device model, serial number, firmware version, user capacity, etc., of the hard disk (`sda`).

You can also use the `hdparm` command:

```
hdparm -I /dev/sda
```

`hdparm` can give much more information than `smartctl`.

—Munish Kumar,
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Writing an ISO image file to a CD-ROM from the command line

We usually download ISO images of popular Linux distros for installation or as live media, but end up using a GUI CD burning tool to create a bootable CD or DVD ROM. But, if you're feeling a bit geeky, you could try doing so from the command line too:

```
# cdrecord -v speed=0 driveopts=burnfree -eject dev=1,0,0  
<src_iso_file>
```

`speed=0` instructs the program to write the disk at the lowest possible drive speed. But, if you are in a hurry, you can try `speed=1` or `speed=2`. Keep in mind that these are relative speeds.

The `-eject` switch instructs the program to eject the disk after the operation is complete.

Now, the most important part to specify is the device's ID. It is absolutely important that you specify the device ID of your CD ROM drive correctly or you may end up writing the ISO to some other place on the disk and corrupting your entire hard disk. To find out the device ID of your CD ROM drive, just run the following command prior to running the first command:

```
#cdrecord -scanbus
```

Your CD ROM's device ID should look something like what's shown below:

```
1,0,0
```

Also, note that you cannot create a bootable DVD disk using this command. But, do not be disheartened—there is another simpler command to burn a bootable DVD, which is:

```
# growisofs -dvd-compat -speed=0 -Z /dev/dvd=myfile.iso
```

Here, `/dev/dvd` is the device file that represents your DVD ROM. It is quite likely to be the same on your system as well.

Do not use `growisofs` to burn a CD ROM. The beauty of Linux

is that a single command does a single operation and does it well.

—Pankaj Rane,
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Downloading/converting HTML pages to PDF

`wkhtmltopdf` is a software package that converts HTML pages to PDF. If this is not installed on your system, use the following command to do so:

```
$sudo apt-get install wkhtmltopdf
```

After installing, you can run the command using the following syntax:

```
$wkhtmltopdf URL[oftheHTMLfile] NAME[of the PDF file].pdf
```

For example, by using:

```
$wkhtmltopdf opensourceforu.com OSFY.pdf
```

...the OSFY.PDF will be downloaded to the current working directory.

You can read the documentation to know more about this.

—Manu Prasad,
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Going invisible on the terminal

Did you ever think that you could type commands that would be invisible on your system but still would execute, provided you typed them correctly? This can easily be done by changing the terminal settings using the following command:

```
stty -echo
```

To restore the visibility of your commands, just type the following command:

```
stty echo
```



Note: Only the 'minus' sign has been removed.

—Sumit Agarwal,
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END

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